FOR YOU, TO TAKE TO THE APPOINTMENT

What to ask your GP for.

You don’t need to explain Medicare to your doctor. You just need to ask for the right thing by name, and know that seeing an Accredited Mental Health Social Worker is covered.

Before you go

Book a longer appointment. A mental health plan takes more than a standard consult, and rushing it is the main reason people leave without one.

Go to your usual GP practice. Since 1 November 2025 the plan, its reviews and the referral need to come from the practice where you are enrolled in MyMedicare, or from your usual GP, for the rebate to apply.

You don’t need a diagnosis first. And you don’t need the plan before you book with us. It only changes what Medicare pays, not whether you can be seen.

Say this

> *“I’d like to talk about a Mental Health Treatment Plan. I’ve found an Accredited Mental Health Social Worker I’d like to see: Lauren Lynch at Body Belonging Clinic. She’s a Medicare provider under Better Access, and she also works by telehealth.”*

If eating, food or body image is part of what’s going on, add:

> *“Could we also look at whether I’m eligible for an Eating Disorder Plan? She’s an Accredited Mental Health Social Worker, so she can work under one, and that’s up to 40 rebated sessions in 12 months instead of 10 a year, plus dietitian sessions.”*

What it costs

A standard session	$200 · 55 minutes
Medicare rebate	$89.50 with a plan and referral
Out of pocket	$110.50. We claim it at the session, so there’s nothing to lodge
Without a plan	$200, no referral needed. You can simply start

If the gap is the problem, say so. There are concession places, and Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander clients are bulk-billed with a valid referral, at no cost. Belonging shouldn’t depend on what you can pay.

If your GP isn’t sure

Plenty of GPs haven’t been told that Accredited Mental Health Social Workers are eligible providers under both Better Access and the Eating Disorder Plan. They are. **Hand them page 2**: it has the item numbers and the details they need. Or ask them to call us on 0493 117 185 and we’ll sort it out directly.

FOR THE REFERRING PRACTITIONER

Referring to an AMHSW.

Everything needed to write the plan and the referral, on one page.

The clinician

Name	Lauren Lynch (she/her)
Accreditation	Accredited Mental Health Social Worker (AMHSW) · AASW #461419
Also credentialed	ANZAED Credentialed Eating Disorder Clinician (CEDC-MH) · verifiable at connected.anzaed.org.au
Practice	Body Belonging Clinic · Perth WA
Delivery	Telehealth across Australia
Contact	0493 117 185 · admin@bodybelongingclinic.com.au · bodybelongingclinic.com.au/referrals

MBS items

Item	Service	Benefit
80160	AMHSW, consulting rooms, ≥50 min	$89.50
91176	AMHSW, video telehealth, ≥50 min	$89.50
82379	Eating disorder treatment, rooms, ≥50 min	$89.50
93103	Eating disorder treatment, video, ≥50 min	$89.50
91175	AMHSW, video, 20 to under 50 min	$63.40

Benefits are the 85% Medicare benefit in force from 1 July 2026. The four $89.50 items each require a session of at least 50 minutes; sessions here run 55.

The two pathways

GP Mental Health Treatment Plan: 10 rebated sessions per calendar year. Since 1 November 2025 the plan, reviews and referral must come from the patient's MyMedicare practice or usual GP, or a psychiatrist or paediatrician.

Medicare Eating Disorder Plan: up to 40 rebated psychological sessions in 12 months, plus up to 20 dietetic sessions. Reviews after sessions 10 (GP), 20 (GP and a psychiatrist or paediatrician; that referral is best made at the initial appointment or the session 10 review) and 30 (GP). AMHSWs are eligible providers.

What we do at our end

Every referral is acknowledged within 2 business days, and we contact the patient directly to arrange a first appointment. Written updates follow at the start of care, at plan review, at closure and whenever risk changes.

Clinical focus: eating disorders and disordered eating (AN, BN, BED, OSFED, ARFID), ADHD and eating, autistic eating, body image and identity affirming care. Treatment focuses on eating, never on weight loss or a target body size. Trauma informed care for children, adolescents, adults and families.

Please include on the referral: the plan type and date, the patient's symptoms or diagnosis, current medications, the number of sessions, your signature and the referral date. Detailed clinical information is welcome by secure email.

Aboriginal-led private practice. Feedback and complaints: admin@bodybelongingclinic.com.au (acknowledged within 7 days), the AASW ethics line 1800 630 124, or in WA the Health and Disability Services Complaints Office 1800 813 583. Medicare figures current 20 October 2026, indexed each 1 July. General scheme information, not medical or billing advice.